



RESEARCH / PROJECT ETHICS REVIEW FORM
For Thesis / Capstone / Dissertation Proposals
 (ver.Oct2024c)

Names of Student Researcher(s):

Bien Aaron C. Miranda
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 Karl Andre F. Aquino
 Shem Matthew J. Salih

Research/Thesis/Capstone Title: WeCycle: Crowdsourcing and Analyzing Cycling Experiences

College: College of Computer Studies

Department: Department of Software Technology

Course: BS Computer Science Major in Software Technology

Expected Duration of the Project: from: AY 24-25 Term 1 to: AY 24-25 Term 3

PROTOCOL:

(To be filled up by proponents; Use the Ethics Checklists as guides in determining areas for ethical concern/consideration. Attach and properly reference the accomplished ethics checklists and supporting documents.)

		Reference Document (include page number)
Target participants	Cyclists (general public, specifically those who use bicycles for commuting or recreation)	Thesis Proposal (pp. 22) Checklist A. Research Ethics Checklist for Investigations involving Human Participants in Thesis Proposal (pp. 50-56)
Data to be used / collected	Cyclist-generated data (video footage, geospatial information, user feedback)	Thesis Proposal (pp. 22-23) Checklist A. Research Ethics Checklist for Investigations involving Human Participants in Thesis Proposal (pp. 50-56) Checklist G. Research Ethics Checklist for Investigators conducting Internet Research in Thesis Proposal (pp. 57-61)

Brief procedure	Participants will use a crowdsourcing platform to submit real-time data about their cycling experiences. This includes video footage, geospatial data such as location, routes, and user feedback as annotations such as rating the safety of a route, commenting on other road users' or their own behaviors. The platform will collect data for use in urban planning and infrastructure development, with the goal of improving cycling accessibility and safety. Data will be collected anonymously unless explicit consent for personal data is provided.	Thesis Proposal (pp. 22-23) Checklist A. Research Ethics Checklist for Investigations involving Human Participants in Thesis Proposal (pp. 50-56)
Potential risks	Cybersecurity concerns related to the storage and transmission of sensitive user data.	Thesis Proposal (pp. 40)
Applicable Terms of Use or Licensing Agreement of Data, Models and/or Tools	- Terms of Service for the platform used to collect data. - Data protection policies ensuring participants' anonymity and the secure handling of collected data. - Licensing agreements for any third-party tools used for application development or geospatial data services.	Thesis Proposal (pp. 40) Informed Consent Form in Thesis Proposal (pp. 62-63) Google Maps Platform Terms of Service (https://cloud.google.com/maps-platform/terms) Google Play Developer Distribution Agreement (https://play.google/intl/en_us/developer-distribution-agreement.html) Apple Developer Program License Agreement (https://developer.apple.com/support/terms/apple-developer-program-license-agreement)
Steps to safeguard the participants and/or data	1. Data will be anonymized to ensure that participants' identities remain protected.	Thesis Proposal (pp. 22-23, 40)

	2. Participants will be informed about the data collection process and their right to opt-out at any stage. 3. Only authorized personnel will have access to the collected data, which will be stored securely. 4. Data will be kept only for the duration necessary to complete the study.	Checklist A. Research Ethics Checklist for Investigations involving Human Participants in Thesis Proposal (pp. 50-56)
Other concerns and considerations	The researchers will be promoting transparency about the purpose of the crowdsourcing platform and its use in improving urban cycling infrastructure. Additionally, The researchers will ensure that data collected will only be used for the specified research purposes and not for commercial activities.	Informed Consent Form in Thesis Proposal (pp. 62-63)

PANEL'S ASSESSMENT/COMMENTS:

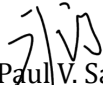
The group has addressed all ethical concerns about the study design and the data store of the proposed crowdsourcing platform.

PANEL'S DECISION:

- ☒ **Approved** (*Proponent/s may proceed with the study/data collection*)
- ☐ **Modifications Required** (*Proponent/s should address ethical issues, follow the panel's recommendations for required modifications, and resubmit the Ethics Review Form for approval before proceeding with the study or before starting with data collection*)
- ☐ **For Full Review** (*Proponent/s should submit the proposal to the University Research Ethics Review Committee (RERC) and obtain a research ethics clearance before proceeding with the study or before starting with data collection*)

JUSTIFICATION:

The study design has addressed all ethical considerations.


Briane Paul V. Samson, PhD

Name and Signature of Adviser/Mentor

Date: 5 Dec 2024


Arren Matthew C. Antioquia

Name and Signature of Panel Member

Date: 5 Dec 2024


Michelle T. Cirunay, PhD

Name and Signature of Panel Member

Date: 6 Dec 2024


Briane Paul V. Samson, PhD

Name and Signature of Panel Member

Date: 5 Dec 2024